



SHARAD SAXENA

EGGING IT ON: A poultry farm in Bihar

ordered 1.20 lakh birds to be distributed among six state-run poultry farms, three of which will be opened shortly. Being a vegetarian himself, Modi was once instrumental in striking off a proposal seeking inclusion of eggs in the Mid-Day meal menu in government schools.

"We want to ramp up egg production in Bihar because today roughly 60 per cent of the eggs consumed here are imported from Andhra Pradesh, the country's largest egg producer," says Modi. No wonder the deputy chief minister wants to set up more poultry farms in Bihar for "employment generation purposes". And if this gives rise to non-vegetarianism, so be it. Some food for thought.

by Amitabh Srivastava

Food for Thought

PATNA Deputy Chief Minister Sushil Kumar Modi wants more eggs on the plates of his people. The reason: each person in the third most populous state in the country consumes just 10 eggs annually. "This is 18 times less than what Indian Council of Medical Research prescribes for

every individual. Bihar is at the bottom of egg-consuming states in the country. We now want to at least double it in the near future," says Dr J.N. Singh, a researcher with the state Animal Husbandry Department.

To ensure that the state is more egg-friendly, the Government has

Funds of Piety

BANGALORE The misuse of funds in temples has pushed the B.S. Yeddyurappa Government into calling tenders for installing electronic *hundis* (donation boxes) that will automatically count collections and prevent pilferage. The Government is concerned about the disrepair of about 24,000 of the



HK RAJASHEKAR

Encasing temples

36,000 temples in the state. Three teams have been set up to prepare cost estimates for the renovation of temples. The first step is to monitor cash donations and ensure that pilferage is done away with. Also, temples will be graded according to the donations they receive.

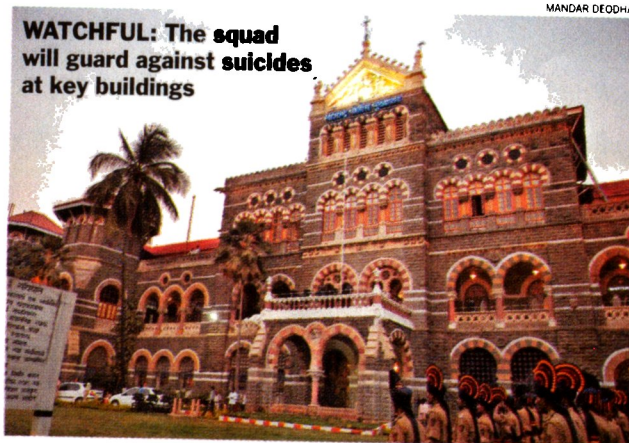
There are about 85 temples in Karnataka that draw donations of over Rs 10 lakh per year. The revenue from all temples in the state is about Rs 100 crore. Also on the agenda is a plan to lease 2.5 acres of land from the wealthy Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams in Andhra Pradesh to construct 1,000 rooms through private contributions. This will accommodate pilgrims from Karnataka visiting the Tirupati temple. The pilgrim's progress seems to be getting better in Karnataka.

by Nirmala Ravindran

Strict Beat

MUMBAI One suicide attempt outside Chief Minister Vilasrao Deshmukh's chamber on the first day of the Assembly's monsoon session, and the police have a combat plan in place. To prevent suicide bids and protests near important offices in south Mumbai, the state police have formed a special Anti-Suicide Squad (ASS). "The squad was formulated in view of the monsoon Assembly session," says DCP (Zone I) Vishwas Nangre-Patil. The officials of this team will not only prevent suicide attempts and self-immolation bids, but will also gather intelligence.

WATCHFUL: The squad will guard against suicides at key buildings



MANDAR DEODHAR

Formed on July 15, the ASS consists of a sub-inspector and 10 male and five women constables. They will man important public offices like Mantralaya, state Police Headquarters, Mumbai Police Headquarters and the Bombay High Court. "The jurisdiction of the squad extends to Azad

Maidan and Marine Drive, since these areas house important government offices," adds Nangre-Patil. The squad is equipped to tackle contingency situations. It has the authority to take punitive action like filing affidavits and registering non-cognisable reports against offenders.

by Swati Mathur